"I'll never be able to trust anyone again."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After betrayal by a spouse, friend, parent, or church, trust feels dangerous. We learn to scan for signs, hold back, and avoid vulnerability. Protecting ourselves makes sense, but if the vow becomes "never," we can end up isolated, protected from pain and also from healing.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not call us to naive trust. "The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps." It also says, "Trust in the LORD with all your heart." God can be trusted perfectly, and people can be trusted in proportion to their character. God promises to heal: "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." And speaking of a wounded people, "I will allure her... and speak to her tenderly. There I will... make the Valley of Achor into a gateway of hope." Trust can be rebuilt slowly, with wisdom.

> *"Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding"* (Proverbs 3:5).

Also see

> "The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps" (Proverbs 14:15).

> "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds" (Psalm 147:3).

> "'Therefore, behold, I will allure her and lead her to the wilderness, and speak to her tenderly. There I will give back her vineyards and make the Valley of Achor into a gateway of hope. There she will respond as she did in the days of her youth, as in the day she came up out of Egypt.'" (Hosea 2:14–15).

> "Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: 'Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!'" (Isaiah 43:1).

Common self-statements

- I will never let anyone close again.
- Everyone will let me down.
- It is safer to rely only on myself.
- I cannot read people anymore.
- I was a fool to trust.
- I will always expect the worst.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating one betrayal as proof about everyone.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must trust completely or not at all.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be betrayed.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that trust is dangerous.

Challenging questions

- What exactly happened, and what did I learn about warning signs?

- Have I known trustworthy people before and since?
- What does trust in small steps look like, as opposed to all or nothing?
- What would be a wise first step to trust someone a little?
- What does God say about trusting Him as I heal?
- What do I need to heal first?

Truth summary

> Trust can be rebuilt wisely, step by step. I do not have to trust everyone, and I do not have to trust no one. I can trust God fully, trust people in proportion to their character, and let Him heal my heart.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Hardship
- Divorce
- Forgiveness
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll never be able to trust anyone again"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll never be able to trust anyone again." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What happened?
- ☐ What warning signs did I learn?
- ☐ Who is trustworthy?
- ☐ What small step can I take?
- ☐ What does God say about healing?
- ☐ What do I need first?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The prudent watch their steps.
- ☐ I can trust God fully.
- ☐ Trust can be earned in small steps.
- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.
- ☐ A gateway of hope can open.
- ☐ Not everyone is the one who hurt me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 3:5**
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding."
- ☐ **Psalm 147:3**
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ **Hosea 2:14–15**
  "'Therefore, behold, I will allure her and lead her to the wilderness, and speak to her tenderly. There I will give back her vineyards and make the Valley of Achor into a gateway of hope. There she will respond as she did in the days of her youth, as in the day she came up out of Egypt.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Small, wise trust: Each week, note one small act of trust and the result.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 3:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I trust the Lord fully, and I can trust people wisely and slowly.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Learn from it. Write what warning signs you can recognize next time.
- [ ] List trustworthy qualities. Write what consistency, honesty, and kindness look like.
- [ ] Test small. Share a small thing with a person who shows these qualities.
- [ ] Seek healing. Consider counseling to process the betrayal.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll never be able to trust anyone again": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A small step of trust
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll never be able to trust anyone again.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I was deeply hurt. Heal my heart, give me wisdom to discern, and teach me to trust You fully. Lead me to people who are safe, and help me risk trust again in small steps. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“Because my marriage ended, I'm a failure.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Divorce comes with shame, whether we initiated it or not. We may feel judged by family or church, and haunted by what we could have done. The word “failed” attaches to the marriage and then to us, and it can quietly become our identity.

What Scripture teaches

Isaiah says, “Do not be afraid, for you will not be put to shame; do not be intimidated, for you will not be humiliated.” Paul writes, “There is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.” The psalmist says, “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted.” God says, “Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!” A marriage can end for many reasons: abuse, betrayal, abandonment, or the failures of both people. Where we did contribute, God offers forgiveness and renewal. Our identity is not “divorced” but “redeemed.”

> *“Do not be afraid, for you will not be put to shame; do not be intimidated, for you will not be humiliated. For you will forget the shame of your youth and will remember no more the reproach of your widowhood”* (Isaiah 54:4).

Also see

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” (Romans 8:1).

> “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit” (Psalm 34:18).

> “Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: ‘Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!’” (Isaiah 43:1).

> “I will repay you for the years eaten by locusts— the swarming locust, the young locust, the destroying locust, and the devouring locust— My great army that I sent against you” (Joel 2:25).

Common self-statements

- I failed at the most important commitment.
- I am a failure as a spouse.
- I should have tried harder.
- God cannot use me now.
- People see me as a failure.
- I wasted years.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Calling myself a failure instead of describing an ended marriage.
- Personalization: Taking sole responsibility for a two-person outcome.
- Hindsight bias: Judging past choices by what I know now.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing the marriage as a total failure and myself as worthless.

Challenging questions

- What actually happened, and what were my part and my spouse's part?
- Were there factors beyond my control, such as abuse, infidelity, or abandonment?
- What would I say to a friend whose marriage ended this way?
- What does Scripture say about shame and redemption?
- What have I learned that I can carry forward?
- Who can help me process this?

Truth summary

> A marriage ending is a real loss, but it does not make me a failure. Where I have fallen short, God forgives. I am redeemed and called by name, and I do not have to carry shame. I can learn, heal, and begin again.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Divorce
- Guilt/Shame
- Forgiveness
- Hardship
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

This Is Amazing Grace — Phil Wickham
Christ bears the burden of rescue rather than demanding self-salvation.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Because my marriage ended, I'm a failure"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Because my marriage ended, I'm a failure." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What actually happened?
- ☐ What was my part and what was not?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What have I learned?
- ☐ Who can support me?
- ☐ Who am I in Christ?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I will not be put to shame.
- ☐ There is no condemnation in Christ.
- ☐ The Lord is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ I am redeemed and called by name.
- ☐ God can restore what was lost.
- ☐ I am more than my marriage status.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 54:4
  "Do not be afraid, for you will not be put to shame; do not be intimidated, for you will not be humiliated. For you will forget the shame of your youth and will remember no more the reproach of your widowhood."
- ☐ Romans 8:1
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Isaiah 43:1
  "Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: 'Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Redeemed, not defined: Each week, write one sentence about who you are besides "divorced."
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 54:4 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will not be put to shame, because I am redeemed.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Divorce" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Tell the story honestly. Write what happened with facts, not labels.
- [ ] Confess and receive. Bring your part to God and receive forgiveness.
- [ ] Find support. Join a divorce recovery group or see a counselor.
- [ ] Read Isaiah 54. Let God's words to the shamed speak to you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Because my marriage ended, I'm a failure": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Redeemed, not defined
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Because my marriage ended, I'm a failure.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I carry shame over my marriage ending. Forgive me where I failed, heal what was broken, and remind me that I am Yours. Redeem the years that were lost. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"If I had been better, they would not have left."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When someone leaves a marriage, a friendship, or a family, we look for the reason, and we often settle on ourselves because that gives us a sense of control. If only I had been more attractive, more patient, more successful, then they would have stayed. The belief can hold us in guilt long after the relationship has ended.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says, "Each of us will give an account of himself to God." Another person's choice to leave is theirs. God's own heart on broken faith is clear: "So guard yourselves in your spirit and do not break faith." The psalmist says, "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted," and "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." We can honestly look at our part, make changes, and still know that we could not have forced anyone to stay. Better would not have guaranteed that they would remain.

> *"So then, each of us will give an account of himself to God"* (Romans 14:12).

Also see

> "If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone" (Romans 12:18).

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit" (Psalm 34:18).

> "'For I hate divorce,' says the LORD, the God of Israel. 'He who divorces his wife covers his garment with violence,' says the LORD of Hosts. So guard yourselves in your spirit and do not break faith" (Malachi 2:16).

> "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds" (Psalm 147:3).

Common self-statements

- It is my fault they left.
- If I had changed, they would be here.
- I drove them away.
- I was not good enough.
- I should have done more.
- Everything would be different if I were different.

Common logical errors

- Personalization: Treating another person's choice as my responsibility.
- Hindsight bias: Believing I should have known what to do.
- Magical thinking: Believing the right behavior would have guaranteed their staying.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding that I am to blame.

Challenging questions

- What would I have had to do, and is it realistic to think it would have worked?
- What responsibility did the other person have for their choices?
- What do I know now that I did not know then?
- Where do I need to own real mistakes and ask forgiveness?

- What does it mean that “each of us will give an account of himself”?
- What would I tell a friend who said this?

Truth summary

> I can own my real mistakes without taking responsibility for another person’s choice to leave. I could not have forced them to stay, and my worth does not depend on their decision. I can learn, grieve, and heal.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Divorce
- Guilt/Shame
- Forgiveness
- Grief
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Grief
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God’s care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God’s faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ’s gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

My Plan for Replacing "If I had been better, they would not have left"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I had been better, they would not have left." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What was mine to own?
- ☐ What was theirs?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What can I learn?
- ☐ Who can I grieve with?
- ☐ What do I need to forgive?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Each person answers for their own choices.
- ☐ I could not have forced anyone to stay.
- ☐ I can own my part without owning theirs.
- ☐ The Lord is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ He heals my wounds.
- ☐ My worth does not depend on their decision.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 14:12
  "So then, each of us will give an account of himself to God."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Mine and theirs: Each week, list one thing that was mine to own and one thing that was theirs.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 14:12 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Each of us answers for our own choices, and I could not force them to stay.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Divorce" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Divide the responsibility. Make two columns of what was mine and what was theirs.
- ☐ Seek forgiveness where due. Confess real mistakes to God and, if appropriate, to others.
- ☐ Grieve. Allow sadness with a trusted listener or counselor.
- ☐ Say Romans 14:12 aloud. Remind yourself that you answer for you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I had been better, they would not have left": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Mine and theirs
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I had been better, they would not have left.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I replay what I could have done. Show me what is mine to own and what is not. Forgive me where I failed and heal the wound of being left. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“Everyone I love eventually betrays me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Repeated hurt by parents, partners, friends, or church can form a pattern: love ends in betrayal. We may expect it, pull away early, or test people until they fail. Sometimes we choose people who repeat the pattern, and the belief is then confirmed.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest about betrayal. The psalmist writes, “It is not an enemy who insults me… But it is you, a man like myself, my companion and close friend,” and “Even my close friend whom I trusted… has lifted up his heel against me.” Isaiah says of the Messiah, “He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief.” Jesus was betrayed by Judas and denied by Peter. Yet after Peter’s failure, Jesus restored him. And God promises, “Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.” You are not alone in betrayal, and betrayal is not the final word.

> *“For it is not an enemy who insults me; that I could endure. It is not a foe who rises against me; from him I could hide. But it is you, a man like myself, my companion and close friend. We shared sweet fellowship together; we walked with the crowd into the house of God”* (Psalm 55:12–14).

Also see

> “Even my close friend whom I trusted, the one who shared my bread, has lifted up his heel against me” (Psalm 41:9).

> “He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not” (Isaiah 53:3).

> “Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: ‘Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.’” (Hebrews 13:5).

> “When they had finished eating, Jesus asked Simon Peter, ‘Simon son of John, do you love Me more than these?’ ‘Yes, Lord,’ he answered, ‘You know I love You.’ Jesus replied, ‘Feed My lambs.’ Jesus asked a second time, ‘Simon son of John, do you love Me?’ ‘Yes, Lord,’ he answered, ‘You know I love You.’ Jesus told him, ‘Shepherd My sheep.’ Jesus asked a third time, ‘Simon son of John, do you love Me?’ Peter was deeply hurt that Jesus had asked him a third time, ‘Do you love Me?’ ‘Lord, You know all things,’ he replied. ‘You know I love You.’ Jesus said to him, ‘Feed My sheep.’” (John 21:15–17).

Common self-statements

- Everyone leaves in the end.
- Love always ends in betrayal.
- I should expect it.
- I will be hurt again.
- It is only a matter of time.
- I cannot count on anyone.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating repeated hurt as a universal rule.

- Fortune telling: Predicting betrayal.
- Mental filter: Remembering betrayals and forgetting loyal people.
- Self-fulfilling prophecy: Pulling away or testing people and causing the very break I fear.

Challenging questions

- Who has betrayed me, and what do these experiences have in common?
- Who has stayed loyal to me?
- What patterns in my choices or expectations might I need to examine?
- What does it mean that Jesus was betrayed too?
- How did Jesus respond to Peter after his failure?
- What would healthy trust look like?

Truth summary

> I have been betrayed, and the pain is real. But not everyone betrays, and I am not alone. Jesus knows betrayal and promises never to leave me. I can heal, examine my patterns, and learn to trust wisely.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Hardship
- Forgiveness
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Everyone I love eventually betrays me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Everyone I love eventually betrays me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has betrayed me?
- ☐ Who has stayed?
- ☐ What patterns do I notice?
- ☐ What did Jesus experience?
- ☐ How did He treat Peter?
- ☐ What does healthy trust look like?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus knows betrayal.
- ☐ God will never leave me or forsake me.
- ☐ Not everyone betrays.
- ☐ Betrayal is not the last word.
- ☐ Restoration is possible.
- ☐ I can choose and trust wisely.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 55:12–14**
  "For it is not an enemy who insults me; that I could endure. It is not a foe who rises against me; from him I could hide. But it is you, a man like myself, my companion and close friend. We shared sweet fellowship together; we walked with the crowd into the house of God."
- ☐ **Isaiah 53:3**
  "He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not."
- ☐ **Hebrews 13:5**
  "Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: 'Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Loyal people: Each week, name one person who has been loyal and one way you showed appreciation.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Hebrews 13:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God said, 'Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.'""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ List the loyal. Write names of people who have stayed with you.
- ☐ Look at patterns. With a counselor, examine the common threads in your relationships.
- ☐ Read John 21. See how Jesus restored Peter.
- ☐ Pray Hebrews 13:5. Thank God that He stays.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Everyone I love eventually betrays me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Loyal people noted
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Everyone I love eventually betrays me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, You know what betrayal feels like. Heal my wounds, help me see the faithful people around me, and teach me to love and trust wisely. Thank You that You never leave. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I'm damaged goods."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After divorce, abuse, a sexual past, repeated rejection, or being used, many people feel permanently marked. The phrase "damaged goods" may have been said to us, or we may say it ourselves. It treats us like an object that has lost value, and it can shape what we think we deserve in a relationship.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture speaks of healing wounds and not discarding people. "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." The LORD says, "I will restore your health and heal your wounds… because they call you an outcast, Zion, for whom no one cares." Isaiah 61:1 says He came "to bind up the brokenhearted." "If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation." And "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you." People are not goods, and God does not mark down the wounded. The hurt is real, and it is not your identity.

> *"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds"* (Psalm 147:3).

Also see

> "But I will restore your health and heal your wounds, declares the LORD, because they call you an outcast, Zion, for whom no one cares" (Jeremiah 30:17).

> "The Spirit of the Lord GOD is on Me, because the LORD has anointed Me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent Me to bind up the brokenhearted, to proclaim liberty to the captives and freedom to the prisoners" (Isaiah 61:1).

> "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17).

> "Because you are precious and honored in My sight, and because I love you, I will give men in exchange for you and nations in place of your life" (Isaiah 43:4).

Common self-statements

- No one wants someone with my history.
- I am used and worthless.
- I am permanently broken.
- I have less to offer than other people.
- My past has ruined me.
- I do not deserve a good relationship.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Calling myself "damaged goods."
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I am defective.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either whole or ruined.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will love me.

Challenging questions

- Where did the phrase “damaged goods” come from, and who first said it?
- Is a person with a painful history a thing that has lost value?
- What strengths have I developed because of what I survived?
- What does God say about the wounded?
- What would I say to a friend who called herself or himself this?
- What kind of healing would help me most?

Truth summary

> I am not goods, and I am not ruined. I have been wounded, and God heals the brokenhearted. In Christ I am a new creation, precious and honored. I deserve respect and can pursue healing.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Guilt/Shame
- Hardship
- Child Abuse/Neglect
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be expressed honestly while asking God for restoration.

Clean — Natalie Grant
God’s cleansing grace challenges the belief that shame or sin makes a person beyond restoration.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm damaged goods"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm damaged goods." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did this label come from?
- ☐ What have I survived?
- ☐ What strengths do I have?
- ☐ What does God say?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What healing do I need?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.
- ☐ He binds up my wounds.
- ☐ I am a new creation.
- ☐ I am precious and honored.
- ☐ My history is not my identity.
- ☐ I deserve respect.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ Jeremiah 30:17
  "But I will restore your health and heal your wounds, declares the LORD, because they call you an outcast, Zion, for whom no one cares."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Healing and worth: Each day, write one sign of healing and one truth about your worth.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 147:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up my wounds.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the source. Write who called you damaged and what you believe now.
- ☐ Replace the label. Write truthful words about yourself.
- ☐ Seek healing. Consider counseling, especially for abuse or trauma.
- ☐ Read Isaiah 61:1–3. Pray it over your story.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm damaged goods": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

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Tue				
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Thu				
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After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm damaged goods.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You heal the brokenhearted and bind up wounds. Remove the label I have worn. Heal me, restore my worth, and help me see myself as You do. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.